

INCLUDES

- ✓ Course framework
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- ✓ Sample exam questions

AP[®] U.S. History

COURSE AND EXAM DESCRIPTION

Effective
Fall 2023

Sample Exam Questions

The sample exam questions that follow illustrate the relationship between the course framework and the AP U.S. History Exam and serve as examples of the types of questions that appear on the exam. After the sample questions is a table that shows to which skill and learning objective(s) each question relates. The table also provides the answers to the multiple-choice questions.

Section I

PART A: MULTIPLE-CHOICE

Questions 1–4 refer to the following excerpt.

“May it . . . please your most excellent Majesty, that it may be declared . . . in this present parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, That the said colonies and plantations in America have been, are, and of right ought to be, subordinate unto, and dependent upon the imperial crown and parliament of Great Britain; . . . and [they] of right ought to have, full power and authority to make laws and statutes of sufficient force and validity to bind the colonies and people of America, subjects of the crown of Great Britain, in all cases whatsoever.”

The Declaratory Act, passed by the British Parliament in 1766

1. Which of the following contributed most directly to the enactment of the law in the excerpt?
 - (A) The increasing divergence between colonial and British culture in the 1700s
 - (B) Debates over how Britain’s colonies should bear the cost of the Seven Years’ War (French and Indian War)
 - (C) The drafting of a declaration of independence for Britain’s colonies in North America
 - (D) Conflicts between colonists and British army leaders over recognizing Native American sovereignty
2. The actions described in the excerpt most immediately led to
 - (A) Parliament strengthening its approach to generating new tax revenue in the North American colonies
 - (B) major and sometimes violent conflicts emerging between the various colonial regions
 - (C) a colonial convention to call for independence from Britain
 - (D) Britain delegating greater authority to colonial assemblies

3. Which of the following was the American colonists' immediate response to the attempts of the British Parliament to enforce the claims made in the excerpt?
- (A) They acceded to Parliament's authority to regulate colonial commerce.
 - (B) They denied the power of the British king over the colonies.
 - (C) They sought an alliance with France against Great Britain.
 - (D) They initiated boycotts of imported British goods.
4. Debates over the claims of the British Parliament in the excerpt most directly contributed to which of the following later characteristics of the United States government?
- (A) The reservation of some governmental powers for the states
 - (B) The enforcement of term limits for the president
 - (C) The establishment of taxation power in Congress
 - (D) The practice of judicial review by the Supreme Court

Questions 5–7 refer to the following excerpt.

“The Erie Canal poured into New York City [wealth] far exceeding that which its early friends predicted. . . . In the city, merchants, bankers, warehousemen, [and] shippers . . . seized the opportunity to perfect and specialize their services, fostering round after round of business innovations that within a decade of the opening of the Erie Canal had made New York by far the best place in America to engage in commerce. . . .

“. . . Even before its economic benefits were realized fully, rival seaports with hopes of tapping interior trade began to imagine dreadful prospects of permanent eclipse. Whatever spirit of mutual good feeling and national welfare once greeted [internal improvements] now disappeared behind desperate efforts in cities . . . to create for themselves a westward connection.”

John Lauritz Larson, historian, *Internal Improvement: National Public Works and the Promise of Popular Government in the Early United States*, 2001

5. The excerpt best illustrates which of the following developments?
 - (A) The extension of commerce with Native Americans
 - (B) The expansion of access to markets
 - (C) The growth in the internal slave trade
 - (D) The increase in semisubsistence agricultural production
6. Which of the following developments in the early nineteenth century could best be used as evidence to support the argument in the second paragraph of the excerpt?
 - (A) The opposition of some political leaders to providing federal funds for public works
 - (B) The failure of some infrastructure projects to recover their costs
 - (C) The recruitment of immigrant laborers to work on new transportation projects
 - (D) The rise of a regional economy based on the production and export of cotton
7. Which of the following later developments had an effect most similar to that described in the excerpt?
 - (A) The invention of the mechanical reaper in the 1830s
 - (B) The annexation of Texas in the 1840s
 - (C) The growth of political party competition in the 1850s
 - (D) The completion of the first transcontinental railroad in the 1860s

Questions 8–10 refer to the following excerpt.

“The normal condition of all the territory of the United States is that of freedom. That as our Republican fathers, when they had abolished slavery in all our national [western] territory, ordained that ‘no person should be deprived of life, liberty or property, without due process of law,’ it becomes our duty by legislation, whenever such legislation is necessary, to maintain this provision of the Constitution against all attempts to violate it; and we deny the authority of Congress, of a territorial legislature, or of any individuals, to give legal existence to slavery in any territory of the United States.”

Republican Party platform, 1860

8. Which of the following best serves as evidence for the claim that “our Republican fathers . . . had abolished slavery in all our national territory”?
 - (A) The ban on the trans-Atlantic slave trade implemented in 1808
 - (B) The relationship of George Washington and Thomas Jefferson to slavery
 - (C) The provisions of the Northwest Ordinance regarding slavery
 - (D) The agreement to count three-fifths of enslaved people for representation in Congress
9. The ideas expressed in the excerpt were most directly influenced by the
 - (A) nativist movement
 - (B) free-soil movement
 - (C) Texas independence movement
 - (D) temperance movement
10. Republicans asserted that political leaders could not “give legal existence to slavery in any territory of the United States” in order to express opposition against the
 - (A) idea of popular sovereignty exemplified by the Kansas-Nebraska Act
 - (B) removal of American Indians from their homelands
 - (C) recruitment of laborers for Northern factories
 - (D) application of California for statehood

Questions 11–14 refer to the following image from the 1940s.



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11. The image most directly reflects which of the following developments during the early 1940s?
- (A) The wartime repression of civil liberties
 - (B) The emergence of the United States as a world power
 - (C) The limited access to consumer goods during wartime
 - (D) The wartime mobilization of United States society
12. The image was most likely intended to promote
- (A) popular support for federal civil rights legislation to end discrimination
 - (B) the belief that women should have rights equal to those of men
 - (C) the movement of women into jobs traditionally held by men
 - (D) access to union membership for all workers regardless of race or gender

13. Production activities like those depicted in the image most directly contributed to
- (A) calls to limit arms and naval destroyers for the major world powers
 - (B) critical wartime provisioning for the Allies that led to victory
 - (C) efforts to rebuild Western Europe's postwar economy
 - (D) concerns about the political influence of the military-industrial complex
14. In the 1950s, the activities of workers such as those depicted in the image would be most challenged by
- (A) a culture of conformity that emphasized domestic ideals for women
 - (B) an increased need for dual incomes in suburban middle-class families
 - (C) the rise of a second-wave feminist movement in the United States
 - (D) the long-term decline of industrial production in the United States

Questions 15–17 refer to the following excerpt.

“The oath that I have taken is the same oath that was taken by George Washington and by every President under the Constitution. But I assume the Presidency under extraordinary circumstances never before experienced by Americans. This is an hour of history that troubles our minds and hurts our hearts.

“I am acutely aware that you have not elected me as your President by your ballots, and so I ask you to confirm me as your President with your prayers. . . .

“I believe that truth is the glue that holds government together, not only our Government but civilization itself. That bond, though strained, is unbroken at home and abroad.

“In all my public and private acts as your President, I expect to follow my instincts of openness and candor with full confidence that honesty is always the best policy in the end. My fellow Americans, our long national nightmare is over.”

President Gerald Ford, Remarks on Taking the Oath of Office, 1974

15. The remarks in the excerpt were most likely given in response to which of the following?
- (A) Political scandals resulting from the president’s illegal campaign activity
 - (B) Accusations that the adoption of national wage and price controls constituted socialism
 - (C) The growing concern over escalating antiwar protests and the shooting of students at Kent State University
 - (D) The discovery that the president had ordered invasions of Cambodia and Laos
16. The “strained” bond referenced in the excerpt most directly reflected which of the following?
- (A) Increased United States involvement in Vietnam
 - (B) A declining economy and rising energy prices
 - (C) Growing federal support for returning power to states
 - (D) Decreasing public trust in the federal government
17. The events discussed in the excerpt led to which of the following political changes?
- (A) Democrats consolidated political support in areas of the South that Republicans had previously dominated.
 - (B) Republicans overcame divisions within their party with Ronald Reagan’s election as president in 1980.
 - (C) Third-party candidates won increasing numbers of electoral college votes in presidential elections.
 - (D) Congress announced a bipartisan proposal for a Contract with America to regain voters’ trust.

PART B: SHORT-ANSWER QUESTION WITH SECONDARY SOURCE

The following is an example of short-answer question 1 found on the AP Exam.
Note that on the actual AP Exam, students will answer three short-answer questions.

1. “Of all the amusements that bedazzled the single working woman, dancing proved to be her greatest passion. After a long day laboring in a factory or shop, young women dressed themselves in their fanciest finery, put on their dancing shoes, and hurried out to the neighborhood hall, ballroom, or saloon equipped with a dance floor. . . . By the 1910s, over five hundred public dance halls opened their doors each evening throughout greater New York. . . .

“New ballrooms and dance palaces offered a novel kind of social space for their female patrons, enhancing and legitimizing their participation in a public social life. The commercial culture of the dance halls meshed with that of working-class youth in a symbiotic relationship, reinforcing emergent values and ‘modern’ attitudes.”

Kathy Peiss, historian, *Cheap Amusements: Working Women and Leisure in Turn-of-the-Century New York*, 1986

“As strikers thronged the public streets of New York City [in 1909], demonstrated in parades and mass meetings, and picketed in front of factories, they challenged established assumptions about the identity and appearance of political actors and access to public space. These working-class, largely immigrant women comprised a subordinated group long denied an active voice in recognized political forums. By occupying the arena of labor politics through a mass strike, they demanded a voice.”

Nan Enstad, historian, *Ladies of Labor, Girls of Adventure: Working Women, Popular Culture, and Labor Politics at the Turn of the Twentieth Century*, 1999

Using the excerpts above, answer (a), (b), and (c).

- (A) Briefly describe ONE important difference between Peiss’ and Enstad’s historical interpretations of women’s emergence in the public sphere at the turn of the twentieth century.
- (B) Briefly explain how ONE specific historical event, development, or circumstance from the period 1880–1929 that is not specifically mentioned in the excerpts could be used to support Peiss’ argument.
- (C) Briefly explain how ONE specific historical event, development, or circumstance from the period 1880–1929 that is not specifically mentioned in the excerpts could be used to support Enstad’s argument.

Section II

The following are examples of the kinds of free-response questions found on the exam. Note that on the actual AP Exam, students will answer one document-based question and will select one of the three long essay questions to answer.

DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

1. Evaluate the relative importance of different causes for the expanding role of the United States in the world in the period from 1865 to 1910.

In your response you should do the following:

- Respond to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis or claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
- Describe a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.
- Support an argument in response to the prompt using at least four documents.
- Use at least one additional piece of specific historical evidence (beyond that found in the documents) relevant to an argument about the prompt.
- For at least two documents, explain how or why the document's point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience is relevant to an argument.
- Demonstrate a complex understanding of a historical development related to the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.

Document 1

Source: Treaty concerning the Cession of the Russian Possessions in North America by his Majesty the Emperor of all the Russias to the United States of America, June 20, 1867.

His Majesty the Emperor of all the Russias agrees to cede to the United States, by this convention, immediately upon the exchange of the ratifications thereof, all the territory and dominion now possessed by his said Majesty on the continent of America and in the adjacent islands, the same being contained within the geographical limits herein set forth. . . .

The inhabitants of the ceded territory, according to their choice . . . may return to Russia within three years; but if they should prefer to remain in the ceded territory, they, with the exception of uncivilized native tribes, shall be admitted to the enjoyment of all the rights, advantages, and immunities of citizens of the United States, and shall be maintained and protected in the free enjoyment of their liberty, property, and religion. The uncivilized tribes will be subject to such laws and regulations as the United States may, from time to time, adopt in regard to aboriginal tribes of that country. . . .

In consideration of the cession aforesaid, the United States agree to pay . . . seven million two hundred thousand dollars in gold.

Document 2

Source: Josiah Strong, *Our Country: Its Possible Future and Its Present Crisis*, 1885.

It seems to me that God, with infinite wisdom and skill, is training the Anglo-Saxon race for an hour sure to come in the world's future. Heretofore there has always been in the history of the world a comparatively unoccupied land westward, into which the crowded countries of the East have poured their surplus populations. But the widening waves of migration, which millenniums ago rolled east and west from the valley of the Euphrates, meet today on our Pacific coast. There are no more new worlds. The unoccupied arable lands of the earth are limited, and will soon be taken. The time is coming when the pressure of population on the means of subsistence will be felt here as it is now felt in Europe and Asia. Then will the world enter upon a new stage of its history—the *final competition of races, for which the Anglo-Saxon is being schooled*. . . . Then this race of unequaled energy, with all the majesty of numbers and the might of wealth behind it—the representative, let us hope, of the largest liberty, the purest Christianity, the highest civilization—having developed peculiarly aggressive traits calculated to impress its institutions upon mankind, will spread itself over the earth.

Document 3

Source: Captain Alfred Thayer Mahan, *The Interest of America in Sea Power, Present and Future*, 1897.

To affirm the importance of distant markets, and the relation to them of our own immense powers of production, implies logically the recognition of the link that joins the products and the markets,—that is, the carrying trade; the three together constituting that chain of maritime power to which Great Britain owes her wealth and greatness. Further, is it too much to say that, as two of these links, the shipping and the markets, are exterior to our own borders, the acknowledgment of them carries with it a view of the relations of the United States to the world radically distinct from the simple idea of self-sufficingness? . . . There will dawn the realization of America's unique position, facing the older worlds of the East and West, her shores washed by the oceans which touch the one or the other, but which are common to her alone.

Despite a certain great original superiority conferred by our geographical nearness and immense resources,—due, in other words, to our natural advantages, and not to our intelligent preparations,—the United States is woefully unready, not only in fact but in purpose, to assert in the Caribbean and Central America a weight of influence proportioned to the extent of her interests. We have not the navy, and, what is worse, we are not willing to have the navy, that will weigh seriously in any disputes with those nations whose interests will conflict there with our own. We have not, and we are not anxious to provide, the defence of the seaboard which will leave the navy free for its work at sea. We have not, but many other powers have, positions, either within or on the borders of the Caribbean.

Document 4

Source: *The Boston Globe*, May 28, 1898.



Courtesy of the Library of Congress #LC-USZ62-91465

Document 5

Source: John Hay, United States Secretary of State, The Second Open Door Note, July 3, 1900.

To the Representatives of the United States at Berlin, London, Paris, Rome, St. Petersburg, and Tokyo Washington, July 3, 1900

In this critical posture of affairs in China it is deemed appropriate to define the attitude of the United States as far as present circumstances permit this to be done. We adhere to the policy . . . of peace with the Chinese nation, of furtherance of lawful commerce, and of protection of lives and property of our citizens by all means guaranteed under extraterritorial treaty rights and by the law of nations. . . . We regard the condition at Pekin[g] as one of virtual anarchy. . . . The purpose of the President is . . . to act concurrently with the other powers; first, in opening up communication with Pekin[g] and rescuing the American officials, missionaries, and other Americans who are in danger; secondly, in affording all possible protection everywhere in China to American life and property; thirdly, in guarding and protecting all legitimate American interests; and fourthly, in aiding to prevent a spread of the disorders to the other provinces of the Empire and a recurrence of such disasters. . . . The policy of the Government of the United States is to seek a solution which may bring about permanent safety and peace to China, preserve Chinese territorial and administrative entity, protect all rights guaranteed to friendly powers by treaty and international law, and safeguard for the world the principle of equal and impartial trade with all parts of the Chinese Empire.

Document 6

Source: *Puck*, a satirical magazine, November 20, 1901.



It's "Up To" Them.
Uncle Sam (to Filipinos.)—You can take your choice!—I have plenty of both!

Courtesy of the Library of Congress #LC-DIG-ppmsca-25583

Document 7

Source: President Theodore Roosevelt, Fourth Annual Message to Congress, December 6, 1904.

There are kinds of peace which are highly undesirable, which are in the long run as destructive as any war. Tyrants and oppressors have many times made a wilderness and called it peace. Many times peoples who were slothful or timid or shortsighted, who had been enervated by ease or by luxury, or misled by false teachings, have shrunk in unmanly fashion from doing duty that was stern and that needed self-sacrifice, and have sought to hide from their own minds their shortcomings, their ignoble motives, by calling them love of peace. . . .

It is our duty to remember that a nation has no more right to do injustice to another nation, strong or weak, than an individual has to do injustice to another individual; that the same moral law applies in one case as in the other. But we must also remember that it is as much the duty of the Nation to guard its own rights and its own interests as it is the duty of the individual so to do. . . .

It is not true that the United States feels any land hunger or entertains any projects as regards the other nations of the Western Hemisphere save such as are for their welfare. All that this country desires is to see the neighboring countries stable, orderly, and prosperous. Any country whose people conduct themselves well can count upon our hearty friendship. If a nation shows that it knows how to act with reasonable efficiency and decency in social and political matters, if it keeps order and pays its obligations, it need fear no interference from the United States. Chronic wrongdoing, or an impotence which results in a general loosening of the ties of civilized society, may in America, as elsewhere, ultimately require intervention by some civilized nation, and . . . the exercise of an international police power.

LONG ESSAY QUESTION

The following is an example of a long essay question. Free-response questions 2, 3, and 4 in Section II of the AP Exam are long essay questions, and students will select one question of the three to answer.

2. Evaluate the extent to which the ratification of the United States Constitution fostered change in the function of the federal government in the period from 1776 to 1800.

In your response you should do the following:

- Respond to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis or claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
- Describe a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.
- Support an argument in response to the prompt using at least two pieces of specific and relevant evidence.
- Use historical reasoning (e.g., comparison, causation, continuity or change) to frame or structure an argument that addresses the prompt.
- Demonstrate a complex understanding of a historical development related to the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.

Answer Key and Question Alignment to Course Framework

Multiple-Choice Question	Answer	Skill	Learning Objective
1	B	1.B	Unit 3: Learning Objective B
2	A	1.A	Unit 3: Learning Objective C
3	D	1.A	Unit 3: Learning Objective C
4	C	5.B	Unit 3: Learning Objective J
5	B	4.A	Unit 4: Learning Objective E
6	A	3.D	Unit 4: Learning Objective C
7	D	5.A	Unit 6: Learning Objective B
8	C	3.D	Unit 3: Learning Objective H
9	B	4.A	Unit 5: Learning Objective F
10	A	1.B	Unit 5: Learning Objective G
11	D	4.A	Unit 7: Learning Objective L
12	C	2.A	Unit 7: Learning Objective L
13	B	1.A	Unit 7: Learning Objective M
14	A	5.B	Unit 8: Learning Objective F
15	A	2.A	Unit 8: Learning Objective J
16	D	4.A	Unit 8: Learning Objective J
17	B	5.B	Unit 9: Learning Objective B

Short-Answer Question	Skill	Learning Objective
1	3.C, 3.D	Unit 6: Learning Objective I Unit 7: Learning Objective G

Free-Response Question	Question Type	Skill	Thematic Focus	Learning Objective
1	Document-based	1.B, 2.B, 2.C, 3.C, 3.D, 4.A, 6.A, 6.B, 6.D	WOR	Unit 7: Learning Objectives B, C, O
2	Long essay	4.A, 6.A, 6.B, 6.C, 6.D	PCE	Unit 3: Learning Objectives J, H, L, P

The scoring information for the questions within this course and exam description, along with further exam resources, can be found on the [AP U.S. History Exam Page](#) on AP Central.

AP History Rubrics

Introductory notes:

- Except where otherwise noted, each point of the rubric is earned independently. For instance, a student could earn a point for evidence beyond the documents without earning a point for thesis/claim.
- Accuracy: The components of this rubric each require that students demonstrate historically defensible content knowledge. Given the timed nature of the exam, a response may contain errors that do not detract from its overall quality, as long as the historical content used to advance the argument is accurate.
- Clarity: Exam essays should be considered first drafts and thus may contain grammatical errors. Those errors will not be counted against a student unless they obscure the successful demonstration of the content knowledge, skills, and reasoning processes described in the rubrics.

AP History DBQ Rubric (7 points)

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	Decision Rules
A. THESIS/CLAIM (0–1 pt)	1 pt. Responds to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis/claim that establishes a line of reasoning.	<i>To earn this point, the thesis must make a claim that responds to the prompt rather than restating or rephrasing the prompt. The thesis must consist of one or more sentences located in one place, either in the introduction or the conclusion.</i>
B. CONTEXTUALIZATION (0–1 pt)	1 pt. Describes a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.	<i>To earn this point, the response must describe broader historical events, developments, or processes that occur before, during, or continue after the time frame of the prompt that are relevant to the topic. This point is not awarded for merely a phrase or reference.</i>

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	Decision Rules
C. EVIDENCE (0–3 pts)	Evidence From the Documents 1 pt. Uses the content of at least three documents to address the topic of the prompt. OR 2 pts. Supports an argument in response to the prompt using at least four documents.	<i>To earn one point, the response must accurately describe — rather than simply quote — the content from at least three of the documents.</i> <i>To earn two points, the response must accurately describe — rather than simply quote — the content from at least four documents. In addition, the response must use the content of the four documents to support an argument in response to the prompt.</i>
	Evidence Beyond the Documents 1 pt. Uses at least one additional piece of specific historical evidence (beyond that found in the documents) relevant to an argument in response to the prompt.	<i>To earn this point, the response must describe the evidence and must use more than a phrase or reference. This additional piece of evidence must be different from the evidence used to earn the point for contextualization.</i>

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	Decision Rules
D. ANALYSIS AND REASONING (0–2 pts)	1 pt. For at least two documents, explains how or why the document's point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience is relevant to an argument.	To earn this point, the response must explain how or why (rather than simply identifying) the document's point of view, purpose, historical situation, or audience is relevant to an argument about the prompt for each of the two documents sourced.
	1 pt. Demonstrates a complex understanding of the historical development that is the focus of the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.	A response may demonstrate a complex understanding through sophisticated argumentation that is relevant to the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: - Explaining multiple themes or perspectives to explore complexity or nuance; OR - Explaining multiple causes or effects, multiple similarities or differences, or multiple continuities or changes; OR - Explaining both cause and effect, both similarity and difference, or both continuity and change; OR - Explaining relevant and insightful connections within and across periods or geographical areas. These connections should clearly relate to an argument that responds to the prompt. A response may demonstrate a complex understanding through effective use of evidence relevant to an argument that addresses the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: - Effectively using seven documents to support an argument that responds to the prompt; OR - Explaining how the point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience of at least four documents supports an argument that responds to the prompt; OR - Using documents and evidence beyond the documents effectively to demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of different perspectives relevant to the prompt. This complex understanding must be part of the argument and may be demonstrated in any part of the response. While it is not necessary for this complex understanding to be woven throughout the response, it must be more than merely a phrase or reference.

AP History Long Essay Question Rubric

AP History LEQ Rubric (6 points)

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	Decision Rules
A. THESIS/CLAIM (0–1 pt)	1 pt. Responds to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis/claim that establishes a line of reasoning.	<i>To earn this point, the thesis must make a claim that responds to the prompt, rather than restating or rephrasing the prompt. The thesis must consist of one or more sentences located in one place, either in the introduction or the conclusion.</i>
B. CONTEXTUALIZATION (0–1 pt)	1 pt. Describes a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.	<i>To earn this point, the response must describe broader historical events, developments, or processes that occur before, during, or continue after the time frame of the prompt that are relevant to the topic. This point is not awarded for merely a phrase or a reference.</i>
C. EVIDENCE (0–2 pts)	1 pt. Provides specific examples of at least two pieces of evidence relevant to the topic of the prompt. OR 2 pts. Supports an argument in response to the prompt using at least two pieces of specific and relevant evidence.	<i>To earn one point, the response must identify specific historical examples relevant to the topic of the prompt.</i> <i>To earn two points the response must use specific historical evidence to support an argument in response to the prompt.</i>

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		Decision Rules
D. ANALYSIS AND REASONING (0–2 pts)	1 pt. Uses historical reasoning (e.g. comparison, causation, CCOT) to frame or structure an argument that addresses the prompt.	OR 2 pts. Demonstrates a complex understanding of the historical development that is the focus of the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.	To earn the first point, the response must demonstrate the use of historical reasoning to frame or structure an argument, although the reasoning might be uneven or imbalanced, or the evidence may be overly general or lacking specificity. To earn the second point, the response may demonstrate a complex understanding through sophisticated argumentation that is relevant to the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: ▪ Explaining multiple themes or perspectives to explore complexity or nuance; OR ▪ Explaining multiple causes or effects, multiple similarities or differences, or multiple continuities or changes; OR ▪ Explaining both cause and effect, both similarity and difference, or both continuity and change; OR ▪ Explaining relevant and insightful connections within and across periods or geographical areas. These connections should clearly relate to an argument that responds to the prompt. A response may demonstrate a complex or nuanced understanding through effective use of evidence relevant to an argument that addresses the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: ▪ Explaining how multiple pieces of specific and relevant evidence (at least four) support a nuanced or complex argument that responds to the prompt; OR ▪ Using evidence effectively to demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of different perspectives relevant to the prompt. This complex understanding must be part of the argument and may be demonstrated in any part of the response. While it is not necessary for this complex understanding to be woven throughout the response, it must be more than merely a phrase or reference.



Scoring Guidelines

Part B: Short-Answer Question with Secondary Source

1. “Of all the amusements that bedazzled the single working woman, dancing proved to be her greatest passion. After a long day laboring in a factory or shop, young women dressed themselves in their fanciest finery, put on their dancing shoes, and hurried out to the neighborhood hall, ballroom, or saloon equipped with a dance floor. . . . By the 1910s, over five hundred public dance halls opened their doors each evening throughout greater New York. . . . “New ballrooms and dance palaces offered a novel kind of social space for their female patrons, enhancing and legitimizing their participation in a public social life. The commercial culture of the dance halls meshed with that of working-class youth in a symbiotic relationship, reinforcing emergent values and ‘modern’ attitudes.”

Kathy Peiss, historian, *Cheap Amusements: Working Women and Leisure in Turn-of-the-Century New York*, 1986

“As strikers thronged the public streets of New York City [in 1909], demonstrated in parades and mass meetings, and picketed in front of factories, they challenged established assumptions about the identity and appearance of political actors and access to public space. These working-class, largely immigrant women comprised a subordinated group long denied an active voice in recognized political forums. By occupying the arena of labor politics through a mass strike, they demanded a voice.”

Nan Enstad, historian, *Ladies of Labor, Girls of Adventure: Working Women, Popular Culture, and Labor Politics at the Turn of the Twentieth Century*, 1999

Using the excerpts above, answer (a), (b), and (c).

- (A) Briefly describe ONE important difference between Peiss’ and Enstad’s historical interpretations of women’s emergence in the public sphere at the turn of the twentieth century.
- (B) Briefly explain how ONE specific historical event, development, or circumstance from the period 1880–1929 that is not specifically mentioned in the excerpts could be used to support Peiss’ argument.
- (C) Briefly explain how ONE specific historical event, development, or circumstance from the period 1880–1929 that is not specifically mentioned in the excerpts could be used to support Enstad’s argument

General Scoring Notes

- Each point is earned independently.
- **Accuracy:** These scoring guidelines require that students demonstrate historically defensible content knowledge. Given the timed nature of the exam, responses may contain errors that do not detract from their overall quality, as long as the historical content used to advance the argument is accurate.
- **Clarity:** Exam responses should be considered first drafts and thus may contain grammatical errors. Those errors will not be counted against a student unless they obscure the successful demonstration of the content knowledge, skills, and reasoning processes described below.
- **Describe:** Provide the relevant characteristics of a specified topic. Description requires more than simply mentioning an isolated term.
- **Explain:** Provide information about how or why a historical development or process occurs or how or why a relationship exists.

Scoring Guidelines for Part B: Short-Answer Question with Secondary Source

3 points

- (A)** Describe one important difference between Peiss's and Enstad's historical interpretations of women's emergence in the public sphere at the turn of the twentieth century. **1 point**

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- Peiss argues that pursuits of entertainment in dance halls by working class women created new, legitimate social spaces for women, however Enstad argues that working women's participation in labor politics gave them a new voice and place in the public sphere.
- Peiss links the growth of women in public social life to a commercial culture that provided opportunities for women to enter the public sphere while Enstad argues that women became political actors who demanded a public voice.

- (B)** Explain how one historical event, development, or circumstance from the period 1880–1929 that is not specifically mentioned in the excerpts could be used to support Peiss's argument. **1 point**

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- Like the dance halls, department stores and amusement parks became aspects of the commercial culture that represented new opportunities for women to enjoy public places as legitimate participants.
- The concept of the New Woman became a cultural phenomenon, as the older idea of separate spheres diminished. The idea of the New Woman supported a more public role for women in the early 1900s.
- The growth of cities and urban America gave young women more opportunities to leave rural America and participate in the developments described by Peiss.
- New technologies such as electric lighting made possible new public spaces for personal freedom for women.

- (C)** Explain how one specific historical event, development, or circumstance from the period 1880–1929 that is not specifically mentioned in the excerpts could be used to support Enstad's argument. **1 point**

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- Women's participation in the suffrage movement, settlement house work, temperance organizing, and the Progressive movement all contributed to modern attitudes about women and increased their roles in the public sphere.
- The ratification of the Nineteenth Amendment to the Constitution gave women the vote and a voice in politics.
- Women were the main participants in the New York shirtwaist strike of 1909. During this strike women made public demands like those described by Enstad.
- Women organized or participated in labor unions such as the International Ladies' Garment Workers' Union (ILGWU) which is an example of their growing voice in the public sphere.
- Working-class women had key public roles in the successful Lawrence (Massachusetts) textile strike of 1912, this demonstrates that women became active political voices through labor movements.

Total for Part B (Question 1)

3 points

Document-Based Question

1. Evaluate the relative importance of different causes for the expanding role of the United States in the world in the period from 1865 to 1910.

In your response you should do the following:

- Respond to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis or claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
- Describe a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.
- Support an argument in response to the prompt using at least four documents.
- Use at least one additional piece of specific historical evidence (beyond that found in the documents) relevant to an argument about the prompt.
- For at least two documents, explain how or why the document's point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience is relevant to an argument.
- Demonstrate a complex understanding of a historical development related to the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.

Document 1

Source: Treaty concerning the Cession of the Russian Possessions in North America by his Majesty the Emperor of all the Russias to the United States of America, June 20, 1867.

His Majesty the Emperor of all the Russias agrees to cede to the United States, by this convention, immediately upon the exchange of the ratifications thereof, all the territory and dominion now possessed by his said Majesty on the continent of America and in the adjacent islands, the same being contained within the geographical limits herein set forth. . . .

The inhabitants of the ceded territory, according to their choice . . . may return to Russia within three years; but if they should prefer to remain in the ceded territory, they, with the exception of uncivilized native tribes, shall be admitted to the enjoyment of all the rights, advantages, and immunities of citizens of the United States, and shall be maintained and protected in the free enjoyment of their liberty, property, and religion. The uncivilized tribes will be subject to such laws and regulations as the United States may, from time to time, adopt in regard to aboriginal tribes of that country. . . .

In consideration of the cession aforesaid, the United States agree to pay . . . seven million two hundred thousand dollars in gold.

Document 2

Source: Josiah Strong, *Our Country: Its Possible Future and Its Present Crisis*, 1885.

It seems to me that God, with infinite wisdom and skill, is training the Anglo-Saxon race for an hour sure to come in the world's future. Heretofore there has always been in the history of the world a comparatively unoccupied land westward, into which the crowded countries of the East have poured their surplus populations. But the widening waves of migration, which millenniums ago rolled east and west from the valley of the Euphrates, meet today on our Pacific coast. There are no more new worlds. The unoccupied arable lands of the earth are limited, and will soon be taken. The time is coming when the pressure of population on the means of subsistence will be felt here as it is now felt in Europe and Asia. Then will the world enter upon a new stage of its history—the *final competition of races, for which the Anglo-Saxon is being schooled*. . . . Then this race of unequalled energy, with all the majesty of numbers and the might of wealth behind it—the representative, let us hope, of the largest liberty, the purest Christianity, the highest civilization—having developed peculiarly aggressive traits calculated to impress its institutions upon mankind, will spread itself over the earth.

Document 3

Source: Captain Alfred Thayer Mahan, *The Interest of America in Sea Power, Present and Future*, 1897.

To affirm the importance of distant markets, and the relation to them of our own immense powers of production, implies logically the recognition of the link that joins the products and the markets,—that is, the carrying trade; the three together constituting that chain of maritime power to which Great Britain owes her wealth and greatness. Further, is it too much to say that, as two of these links, the shipping and the markets, are exterior to our own borders, the acknowledgment of them carries with it a view of the relations of the United States to the world radically distinct from the simple idea of self-sufficingness? . . . There will dawn the realization of America's unique position, facing the older worlds of the East and West, her shores washed by the oceans which touch the one or the other, but which are common to her alone.

Despite a certain great original superiority conferred by our geographical nearness and immense resources,—due, in other words, to our natural advantages, and not to our intelligent preparations,—the United States is woefully unready, not only in fact but in purpose, to assert in the Caribbean and Central America a weight of influence proportioned to the extent of her interests. We have not the navy, and, what is worse, we are not willing to have the navy, that will weigh seriously in any disputes with those nations whose interests will conflict there with our own. We have not, and we are not anxious to provide, the defence of the seaboard which will leave the navy free for its work at sea. We have not, but many other powers have, positions, either within or on the borders of the Caribbean.

Document 4

Source: *The Boston Globe*, May 28, 1898.



Courtesy of the Library of Congress #LC-USZ62-91465

Document 5

Source: John Hay, United States Secretary of State, The Second Open Door Note, July 3, 1900.

To the Representatives of the United States at Berlin, London, Paris, Rome, St. Petersburg, and Tokyo Washington, July 3, 1900

In this critical posture of affairs in China it is deemed appropriate to define the attitude of the United States as far as present circumstances permit this to be done. We adhere to the policy . . . of peace with the Chinese nation, of furtherance of lawful commerce, and of protection of lives and property of our citizens by all means guaranteed under extraterritorial treaty rights and by the law of nations. . . . We regard the condition at Pekin[g] as one of virtual anarchy. . . . The purpose of the President is . . . to act concurrently with the other powers; first, in opening up communication with Pekin[g] and rescuing the American officials, missionaries, and other Americans who are in danger; secondly, in affording all possible protection everywhere in China to American life and property; thirdly, in guarding and protecting all legitimate American interests; and fourthly, in aiding to prevent a spread of the disorders to the other provinces of the Empire and a recurrence of such disasters. . . . The policy of the Government of the United States is to seek a solution which may bring about permanent safety and peace to China, preserve Chinese territorial and administrative entity, protect all rights guaranteed to friendly powers by treaty and international law, and safeguard for the world the principle of equal and impartial trade with all parts of the Chinese Empire.

Document 6

Source: *Puck*, a satirical magazine, November 20, 1901.



It's "Up To" Them.
Uncle Sam (to Filipinos).—You can take your choice;—I have plenty of both !

Courtesy of the Library of Congress #LC-DIG-ppmsca-25583

Document 7

Source: President Theodore Roosevelt, Fourth Annual Message to Congress, December 6, 1904.

There are kinds of peace which are highly undesirable, which are in the long run as destructive as any war. Tyrants and oppressors have many times made a wilderness and called it peace. Many times peoples who were slothful or timid or shortsighted, who had been enervated by ease or by luxury, or misled by false teachings, have shrunk in unmanly fashion from doing duty that was stern and that needed self-sacrifice, and have sought to hide from their own minds their shortcomings, their ignoble motives, by calling them love of peace. . . .

It is our duty to remember that a nation has no more right to do injustice to another nation, strong or weak, than an individual has to do injustice to another individual; that the same moral law applies in one case as in the other. But we must also remember that it is as much the duty of the Nation to guard its own rights and its own interests as it is the duty of the individual so to do. . . .

It is not true that the United States feels any land hunger or entertains any projects as regards the other nations of the Western Hemisphere save such as are for their welfare. All that this country desires is to see the neighboring countries stable, orderly, and prosperous. Any country whose people conduct themselves well can count upon our hearty friendship. If a nation shows that it knows how to act with reasonable efficiency and decency in social and political matters, if it keeps order and pays its obligations, it need fear no interference from the United States. Chronic wrongdoing, or an impotence which results in a general loosening of the ties of civilized society, may in America, as elsewhere, ultimately require intervention by some civilized nation, and . . . the exercise of an international police power.

General Scoring Notes

- Except where otherwise noted, each point of these rubrics is earned independently; for example, a student could earn a point for evidence without earning a point for thesis/claim.
- **Accuracy:** The components of these rubrics require that students demonstrate historically defensible content knowledge. Given the timed nature of the exam, essays may contain errors that do not detract from their overall quality, as long as the historical content used to advance the argument is accurate.
- **Clarity:** Exam essays should be considered first drafts and thus may contain grammatical errors. Those errors will not be counted against a student unless they obscure the successful demonstration of the content knowledge, skills, and practices described below

Evaluate the relative importance of different causes for the expanding role of the United States in the world in the period from 1865 to 1910.

Scoring Guidelines for Document-Based Question

7 points

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row A Thesis/Claim (0–1 points)	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Responds to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis/claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Are not historically defensible. - Only restate or rephrase the prompt. - Do not respond to the prompt. - Do not establish a line of reasoning. - Are overgeneralized.	Responses that earn this point: Provide a historically defensible thesis or claim about the causes of the expanding role of the United States in the world in the period from 1865 to 1910. The thesis or claim must either provide some indication of the reason for making that claim OR establish categories of the argument.
	Examples that do not earn this point: Do not focus on the topic of the prompt "American imperialism contributed to calls for isolationist policies after World War I." Provide a historically defensible claim, but do not establish a line of reasoning "The United States gained a lot of territory during this period." Provide a restatement of the prompt "Different causes and events had a major importance in expanding the role of the US in the world."	Examples that earn this point: Establish a line of reasoning with analytic categories "In expanding its role in the world, the United States sought economic opportunity through international business relationships, political opportunity to police the world, and they sought to cultivate other societies to better spread the American culture." "The country was doing this for a few reasons, such as expanding its territory (manifest destiny or imperialism), preserving its national interests such as trading with China, and helping other nations." Establish a line of reasoning that evaluates the topic of the prompt with analytic categories "This change in foreign policy was caused by the need for new markets to expand the US economy and by imperialist sentiment. However, the most important cause of this change in the US's role can be attributed to nationalist and Darwinist sentiment because it was driven emotionally, and therefore was a stronger motive." "While some historians may argue that the US desire to expand its role in the world was due to the fact that the US felt it was its duty to civilize nations and act as a global police, the most important reason for America expanding its role in the world can be attributed to its competition with Europe over global influence, its desire to expand its economy through trading opportunities, and the US ideal of manifest destiny." Establish a line of reasoning "From 1865 to 1910 the United States expanded its role in the world because of the belief in manifest destiny." (Minimally acceptable thesis/claim)
Additional Notes: - The thesis or claim must consist of one or more sentences located in one place, either in the introduction or the conclusion (which may not be limited to the first or last paragraphs). - The thesis or claim must identify a relevant development(s) in the period, although it is not required to encompass the entire period.		

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row B Contextualization (0–1 points)	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Describes a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Provide an overgeneralized statement about the time period referenced in the prompt. - Provide context that is not relevant to the prompt. - Provide a passing phrase or reference. Examples that do not earn this point: Do not provide context relevant to the topic of the prompt <i>"The Civil War brought little meaningful change to the South as sharecropping replaced slavery."</i> Provide a passing phrase or reference <i>"Industrialism happened"</i>	Responses that earn this point: - Accurately describe a context relevant to the causes of the expanding role of the United States in the world in the period from 1865 to 1910. Examples of relevant context that earn this point include the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided: - The impact of the Civil War on the United States' role in the world - International competition to establish colonies and maintain empires from 1865 to 1910 - Increasing United States industrialization and desire to develop new markets for goods - The closing of the frontier in 1890 - Increasing international immigration - US trade with Asia Examples of acceptable contextualization: <i>"In the time period after the Civil War, Europe was growing its colonial empires in Africa and Asia, and the fight for influence and money ensued between the most powerful nations. The United States sought to keep up with Europe and expand its sphere of influence."</i> <i>"After the California Gold Rush, US trade and contact with Asia increased."</i> (Minimally acceptable contextualization)
	Additional Notes: - The response must describe broader historical events, developments, or processes that occur before, during, or continue after the time frame of the question that are relevant to the topic of the prompt. - To earn this point, the context provided must be more than a phrase or reference.	

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		
Row C Evidence (0–3 points)	Evidence from the Documents		
	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Uses the content of at least three documents to address the topic of the prompt.	2 points Supports an argument in response to the prompt using at least four documents
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes		
	Responses that do not earn points: - Use evidence from less than three of the documents - Misinterpret the content of the document - Quote, without an accompanying description, of the content of the documents - Address documents collectively rather than considering separately the content of each document	Responses that earn 1 point: Accurately describe—rather than simply quote—the content from at least three of the documents to address the causes of the expanding role of the United States in the world from 1865 to 1910.	Responses that earn 2 points: Support an argument in response to the prompt by accurately using the content of at least four documents.
		Examples of describing the content of a document: Describe evidence from the documents relevant to the topic but do not use that evidence to support an argument (Document 6): “The image depicts Uncle Sam offering potential colonies the choice between choosing education or war.” (Document 2): “The document demonstrates how many American believed their religion to be superior and had pride in their racial heritage.”	Examples of supporting an argument using the content of a document: (Document 2): “However, social causes were also a factor in the practice of American imperialism. This was seen through the application of Social Darwinism to a global scale. Many felt that Anglo-Saxons were a more fit race than any to expand, and Christianize and civilize the rest of the world (Doc 2).” <i>(Uses evidence from the document to support an argument about a social cause of American imperialism)</i> (Document 3): “Mahan argues that the United States needs a stronger navy to support its growing economy and maintain its power. Having a strong navy meant gaining bases for it around the world.” <i>(Uses evidence from the document to support an argument about economic and military causes for American imperialism)</i>
	Additional Notes: To earn two points, the four documents do not have to be used in support of a single argument—they can be used across sub-arguments or to address counterarguments.		

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row C (continued)	Evidence beyond the Documents:	
	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Uses at least one additional piece of specific historical evidence (beyond that found in the documents) relevant to an argument in response to the prompt.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Provide evidence that is not relevant to an argument about the prompt. - Provide evidence that is outside the time period or region specified in the prompt. - Repeat information that is specified in the prompt or in any of the documents. - Provide a passing phrase or reference.	Responses that earn 1 point: Must use at least one specific piece of historical evidence relevant to an argument about the expanding role of the United States in the world in the period from 1865 to 1910.
		Examples of specific and relevant evidence beyond the documents that earn this point include the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided: - The Spanish-American War - The Filipino-American War - Manifest Destiny - The Annexation of Hawaii - Social Darwinism - William Seward - Mexican Revolution - Missionary Work - Panama Canal - Theodore Roosevelt/Big Stick Diplomacy - Roosevelt Corollary to the Monroe Doctrine - Dollar Diplomacy - Chinese Exclusion Act - Anti-Imperialist League; Peace Movement - Insular Cases - Yellow Journalism

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row C (continued)		Examples of evidence beyond the documents relevant to an argument about the prompt: “Newspapers had risen in popularity among the public, a majority of whom could read, and many companies competed to attract the public’s attention. Yellow journalism created outrageous attitudes with dramatized accounts of Spanish mistreatment of the Cubans, which motivated Americans to support a military intervention.” <i>(Uses a piece of evidence beyond the documents to make a connection to an argument about the prompt)</i>
	Additional Notes: - Typically, statements credited as evidence will be more specific than statements credited as contextualization. - To earn this point, the evidence provided must be different from the evidence used to earn the point for contextualization. - To earn this point, the evidence provided must be more than a phrase or reference. - The point for evidence beyond the documents may be awarded for evidence that appears in any part of the response.	

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row D Analysis and Reasoning (0–2 points)	Sourcing	
	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point For at least two documents, explains how or why the document’s point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience is relevant to an argument.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Explain sourcing for fewer than two of the documents. - Identify the point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience but fail to explain how or why it is relevant to an argument. - Summarize the content or argument of the document without explaining the relevance of this summary to the point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience. Examples that do not earn this point: Identify the point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience, but do not explain how or why it is relevant to an argument “In document 1, the audience is the United States government.” Summarize the content of the document without explaining the relevance of this to the point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience “The purpose of this document was to tell America why Russia was ceding its territory and giving permission.”	Responses that earn this point: - Must explain how or why — rather than simply identifying — the document’s point of view, purpose, historical situation, or audience is relevant to an argument that addresses the prompt for each of the two documents sourced. Example of acceptable explanation of the relevance of the author’s point of view: (Document 4): “The point of view of the artist is actually critical of America’s policy of imperialism, seeing it as a sign of America’s ego in its superiority and greed.” (<i>Connects the point of view of the document relevant to an argument about the ideological and economic causes of American imperialism</i>) Example of acceptable explanation of the relevance of the author’s purpose (Document 6): “Puck, being a satire magazine, likely published this cartoon with the purpose of showing the hypocritical nature of the Spanish-American War; it was fought to liberate Cuba, but it ended with the oppression of the Philippines.” (<i>Connects the purpose of this document of the document relevant to an argument about the ideological causes of the Spanish-American War</i>) Example of acceptable explanation of the relevance of the historical situation of a source: (Document 4): “The cartoon is best understood in the context of the Spanish American War. The Spanish gave up its claims to Cuba and the Philippines, leaving the territory open for the US to take advantage of.” (<i>Connects the historical situation of the document relevant to an argument about the increased possibilities for the United States to exert international influence during the period</i>) Example of acceptable explanation of the relevance of the audience: (Document 5): “As a presidential address to Congress, document 7 likely offers a picture of what Theodore Roosevelt believed to be the most convincing reasons for the United States to grow its standing in the world.” (<i>Connects the audience of the document relevant to an argument that addresses the political justifications for increasing United States participation in the world</i>)

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row D (continued)	Complexity	
	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Demonstrates a complex understanding of the historical development that is the focus of the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
		Responses that earn this point: May demonstrate a complex understanding through sophisticated argumentation that is relevant to the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: - Explaining multiple themes or perspectives to explore complexity or nuance; OR - Explaining multiple causes or effects, multiple similarities or differences, or multiple continuities or changes; OR - Explaining both cause and effect, both similarity and difference, or both continuity and change; OR - Explaining relevant and insightful connections within and across periods or geographical areas. These connections should clearly relate to an argument that responds to the prompt. May demonstrate a complex understanding through effective use of evidence relevant to an argument that addresses the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: - Effectively using seven documents to support an argument that responds to the prompt; OR - Explaining how the point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience of at least four documents supports an argument that responds to the prompt; OR - Using documents and evidence beyond the documents effectively to demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of different perspectives relevant to the prompt. Demonstrating complex understanding might include any of the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided: - Exploring different ways (e.g., via trade, via annexation) in which the role of the United States in the world expanded (<i>Explains nuance</i>) - Explaining both similarities and differences in the United States role in different parts of the world (<i>Explains similarities and differences</i>) - Connecting to other time periods, such as efforts to establish United States international standing in the late 18th and early 19th centuries (<i>Explains relevant and insightful connections</i>) - Confirming the validity of the response's argument by explaining how different documents corroborate the argument in spite of differing perspectives among the authors (<i>Explains relevant and insightful connections</i>) - Explaining how the interplay between markets, technology and politics led to increased American attempts to increase trade in Asia and build the Panama Canal to transport goods (<i>Explains multiple causes or effects</i>) - Qualifying or modifying an argument by considering evidence that shows the limits of the United States role in the world at this time (<i>Qualifies or modifies an argument by considering diverse or alternative views or evidence</i>)

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria
	Additional Notes: • This complex understanding must be part of the argument and may be demonstrated in any part of the response. • While it is not necessary for this complex understanding to be woven throughout the response, it must be more than merely a phrase or reference. • To earn a point for complexity by using seven documents in support of an argument, there must be an attempt to use all seven documents to effectively support an argument, but the use of the documents may be unevenly or inconsistently developed, or the document use may be weaker in one or two instances.

Document Summaries

Document	Summary of Content	Explains the relevance of point of view (POV), purpose, situation, and/or audience by elaborating on examples such as:
1. Treaty concerning Russian possessions, 1867	- Russia cedes territory in North America to the United States for \$7.2 million in gold - Russians in the territory may return to Russia; Native Americans must remain and be subject to United States laws	- United States efforts to acquire Alaska and to remove the presence of foreign powers in North America continued long-standing policies of western expansion across the continent. (situation) - Foreign nations viewed the United States as a more important international power as a result of the treaty. (audience)
2. Strong, Our Country, 1885	- Argues that, with the reduced amount of unoccupied territory in the world, races will soon compete for land - Thinks "Anglo-Saxon" religion and culture have particular merit, and therefore they deserve to control more land	- Advocates of United States imperialism promoted ideas about racial competition and "Anglo-Saxon" superiority. (point of view). - Many Americans perceived themselves to be in competition with other countries around the world for the acquisition of colonial possessions. (situation) - Strong sought to impress on American leaders the need to acquire more land and resources. (purpose)
3. Mahan, Interest of America in Sea Power, 1897	- Claims that Britain's power and influence has been derived by its ability to support its international trade with a powerful navy - Argues United States does not have sufficient naval power to assert its interest in the Caribbean or Central America, nor to protect its own seaboards	- European endeavors in Latin America and in the Far East increased the need for the United States to extend its reach into the region to protect its growing economic interests. (situation) - Some military leaders advocated for the strengthening of domestic fortification and the enlargement of the navy to extend America's influence abroad. (point of view) - Mahan attempted to influence United States political leaders to enlarge the United States Navy to extend its reach into Central America and the Far East. (purpose)
4. Boston Globe cartoon, "Hardly Know Which to Take First," 1898	- Cartoon depicting President William McKinley as a waiter, offering Uncle Sam a menu of territories - Uncle Sam is unsure which to capture first	- The United States engages with Spain in the Spanish-American War over control of islands in Spanish possession. (situation) - The cartoonist portrayed McKinley as serving the interests of the United States imperialists by acquiring these lands in the Far East and Caribbean regions. (point of view)
5. Hay, Second Open Door Note, 1900	Asserts that the United States seeks to achieve peace in China, preserve an independent China, protect all nations' rights there, and ensure free trade there	- The Boxer Rebellion was in progress with anti-Western attacks by Chinese on foreign delegations and missionaries in China. This note was an attempt to respond to these attacks and to protect United States economic interests. (situation) - The United States had not been issued equal trade access, as had other European powers (through so called "spheres of influence"), from the Chinese authorities. This was an attempt to assert the United States' equal right to the markets of China. (situation) - The Note advocated that the United States intervene into the affairs of China in collaboration with the other European powers to put down the Boxer Rebellion. (purpose)

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Document	Summary of Content	Explains the relevance of point of view (POV), purpose, situation, and/or audience by elaborating on examples such as:
6. <i>Puck</i> cartoon, "It's 'Up to' Them," 1901	- Cartoon depicting Uncle Sam offering both soldiers and school teachers to Filipinos. - Suggests United States was willing to use both military force and educational uplift to gain power abroad	- The United States sought to project power overseas by retaining the Philippines as a colony, provoking a Filipino independence movement and insurgency against United States occupation. (situation) - The cartoonist depicted Uncle Sam as an imperialist giving Filipinos a choice between either military conflict or education. (point of view)
7. Theodore Roosevelt, Fourth Annual Message, 1904	- Argues that those who oppose necessary actions in foreign lands are timid and unmanly - Argues that sometimes peace results from engaging in necessary conflict - Argues nations must act to protect their rights and interest - Argues the United States simply wants stability in the Western Hemisphere; countries that behave well will not face United States interference, but those that behave poorly may require United States intervention	- The United States had previously engaged in direct intervention both with military and diplomatic force in numerous parts of Latin America (such as Venezuela, Panama, and elsewhere) for economic and diplomatic reasons and for future endeavors. (situation) - Imperialists advocated for the expansion of United States influence in Latin America to protect United States interests from internal instability and foreign threats. (point of view)

Long Essay Question

2. Evaluate the extent to which the ratification of the United States Constitution fostered change in the function of the federal government in the period from 1776 to 1800.

In your response you should do the following:

- Respond to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis or claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
- Describe a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.
- Support an argument in response to the prompt using at least two pieces of specific and relevant evidence.
- Use historical reasoning (e.g., comparison, causation, continuity or change) to frame or structure an argument that addresses the prompt.
- Demonstrate a complex understanding of a historical development related to the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.

General Scoring Notes

- Except where otherwise noted, each point of these rubrics is earned independently; for example, a student could earn a point for evidence without earning a point for thesis/claim.
- **Accuracy:** The components of these rubrics require that students demonstrate historically defensible content knowledge. Given the timed nature of the exam, essays may contain errors that do not detract from their overall quality, as long as the historical content used to advance the argument is accurate.
- **Clarity:** Exam essays should be considered first drafts and thus may contain grammatical errors. Those errors will not be counted against a student unless they obscure the successful demonstration of the content knowledge, skills, and practices described below.

Evaluate the extent to which the ratification of the United States Constitution fostered change in the function of the federal government in the period from 1776 to 1800.

Scoring Guidelines for Long Essay Question

6 points

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row A Thesis/Claim (0–1 points)	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Responds to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis/claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Are not historically defensible. - Only restate or rephrase the prompt. - Do not respond to the prompt. - Do not establish a line of reasoning. - Are overgeneralized.	Responses that earn this point: Provide a historically defensible thesis or claim about how the ratification of the United States Constitution fostered change in the function of the government in the period from 1776 to 1800. The thesis or claim must either provide some indication of the reason for making that claim OR establish categories of the argument.
	Examples that do not earn this point: Provide a historically defensible claim, but do not establish a line of reasoning <i>"The Constitutional Convention was in 1787."</i> Provide a restatement of the prompt <i>"The ratification of the Constitution transformed the national government."</i> Do not focus on the topic of the prompt <i>"The national government changed socially, politically and economically."</i>	Examples that earn this point: Establish a line of reasoning that evaluates the topic of the prompt with analytic categories <i>"The ratification of the Constitution dramatically changed the function of the federal government by significantly increasing the scope and the distribution of its power. Despite this significant change in the scope and distribution of political power, a considerable amount of authority remained with the states after ratification."</i> Establish a line of reasoning <i>"The ratification of the Constitution transformed the national government from a confederation of states into a more centralized government."</i> <i>(Minimally acceptable thesis/claim)</i>
Additional Notes: - The thesis or claim must consist of one or more sentences located in one place, either in the introduction or the conclusion (which may not be limited to the first or last paragraphs). - The thesis or claim must identify a relevant development(s) in the period, although it is not required to encompass the entire period.		

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row B Contextualization (0–1 points)	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Describes a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Provide an overgeneralized statement about the time period referenced in the prompt. - Provide context that is not relevant to the prompt. - Provide a passing phrase or reference. Examples that do not earn this point: Do not provide context relevant to the topic of the prompt <i>"Many Americans migrated to the West in the 1780s and 1790s."</i>	Responses that earn this point: - Accurately describe a context relevant to how the ratification of the United States Constitution fostered change in the function of the federal government in the period from 1776 to 1800. Examples of relevant context that earn this point include the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided: - The American experience under British government rule - The United States government under the Articles of Confederation - Economic instability of the 1780s and 1790s - The international crises of the 1790s, such as the French Revolution Example of acceptable contextualization: <i>"In the leadup to the American Revolution, the British government passed a variety of taxes on the American colonies without the colonists' consent. This led to many protests and widespread distrust in powerful central governments."</i> <i>"Under the Articles of Confederation, the national government did not have the power to tax." (Minimally acceptable contextualization)</i>
	Additional Notes: - The response must describe broader historical events, developments, or processes that occur before, during, or continue after the time frame of the question that are relevant to the topic of the prompt. - To earn this point, the context provided must be more than a phrase or reference.	

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		
Row C Evidence (0–2 points)	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Provides specific examples of at least two pieces of evidence relevant to the topic of the prompt.	2 points Supports an argument in response to the prompt using at least two pieces of specific and relevant evidence.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes		
	Responses that do not earn points: - Identify a single piece of evidence. - Provide evidence that is not relevant to the topic of the prompt. - Provide evidence that is outside the time period or region specified in the prompt. - Repeat information that is specified in the prompt.	Responses that earn 1 point: <u>Identify at least two specific historical examples</u> relevant to ratification of the United States Constitution from 1776 to 1800.	Responses that earn 2 points: <u>Use at least two specific historical examples</u> to support an argument regarding how the ratification of the United States Constitution fostered change in the function of the federal government from 1776 to 1800.
	Examples that do not earn points: Provide evidence that is not relevant to the topic of the prompt <i>"The 13th Amendment is an example of the increase in the power of the federal government because it abolished slavery."</i>	Examples of evidence that are specific and relevant include the following (two examples required): - Anti-Federalists' role in the ratification debate - Federalists' role in the ratification debate - The role of the Federalist papers in shaping the republic - Alexander Hamilton's role in shaping the republic - John Jay's role in shaping the republic - Thomas Jefferson's role in shaping the republic - James Monroe's role in shaping the republic - The passage of the Northwest Ordinance under the Articles of Confederation - The influence of Shays' Rebellion on the framers of the Constitution - George Washington's role in shaping the republic - The resistance to federal power that occurred during the Whiskey Rebellion Example of a statement that earns one point for evidence: <i>"John Jay and Alexander Hamilton wrote many of the Federalist papers."</i>	Examples that successfully support an argument with evidence: <i>"Alexander Hamilton's arguments in the Federalist papers were a key factor in the ratification of the Constitution and helped justify new and expanded functions of the federal government." (Uses evidence to support an argument about the causes for growing federal power)</i> <i>"The concerns of the Anti-Federalists during the ratification debates led to the addition of the Bill of Rights. The addition of the Bill of Rights actually changed the role of the federal government by explicitly making federal authority a significant guarantor of individual rights." (Uses evidence to support an argument about a change in federal authority)</i> <i>"The suppression of the Whiskey Rebellion is an example of the increased power and authority of the federal government after ratification to collect taxes and maintain domestic order." (Uses evidence to support an argument about the increased authority of the government after ratification)</i>
	Additional Notes: - Typically, statements credited as evidence will be more specific than statements credited as contextualization. - If a response has a multipart argument, then it can meet the threshold of two pieces of evidence by giving one example for one part of the argument and another example for a different part of the argument, but the total number of examples must still be at least two. (For example, using the whiskey tax as evidence of a change in the government's economic function and the proclamation of neutrality as evidence of change in the government's diplomatic function.)		

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		
Row D Analysis and Reasoning (0–2 points)	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Uses historical reasoning (e.g. comparison, causation, continuity and change) to frame or structure an argument that addresses the prompt.	2 points Demonstrates a complex understanding of the historical development that is the focus of the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes		
	Responses that do not earn points: - May include evidence but offer no reasoning to connect the evidence to an argument. - May assert the use of historical reasoning but does not use it to frame or structure an argument.	Responses that earn 1 point: Must demonstrate the use of historical reasoning to frame or structure an argument on how the United States Constitution fostered change in the function of the federal government in the period from 1776 to 1800. The reasoning might be uneven or imbalanced, or the evidence may be overly general or lacking specificity.	Responses that earn 2 points: May demonstrate a complex understanding through sophisticated argumentation that is relevant to the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: - Explaining multiple themes or perspectives to explore complexity or nuance; OR - Explaining multiple causes or effects, multiple similarities or differences, or multiple continuities or changes; OR - Explaining both cause and effect, both similarity and difference, or both continuity and change; OR - Explaining relevant and insightful connections within and across periods or geographical areas. These connections should clearly relate to an argument that responds to the prompt. May demonstrate a complex understanding through effective use of evidence relevant to an argument that addresses the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways that might include: - Explaining how multiple pieces of specific and relevant evidence (at least four) support a nuanced or complex argument that responds to the prompt; OR - Using evidence effectively to demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of different perspectives relevant to the prompt.

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		
Row D <i>(continued)</i>	Examples that do not earn points: Provide evidence but offer no reasoning to connect the evidence to an argument • <i>"The United States constitution, largely written by James Madison, describes the Senate and House of Representatives in article one."</i>	Using a historical reasoning process to frame or structure an argument could include: • Explaining changes in the United States national government from the period under the Articles of Confederation to the period under the Constitution. • Discussing continuities in United States national government—such as its relatively modest power—from the period under the Articles of Confederation to the period under the Constitution. Example of acceptable use of historical reasoning: • <i>"The United States national government changed after the ratification of the Constitution by assuming new functions and responsibilities for new issues, such as maintaining a national army." (Indicates a change as a result of the Constitution.)</i>	Demonstrating complex understanding might include any of the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided: • Assessing both Federalist arguments in favor of the Constitution and Anti-Federalist arguments against it <i>(Explains nuance)</i> • Explaining both continuities in government before and after the Constitution (such as many of the same leaders, the same context of economic crisis) and changes (such as the expansion of federal authority over taxes and economy). <i>(Explains both continuity and change)</i> • Making comparisons with the way that the functions of the federal government changed during the New Deal. <i>(Explains relevant and insightful connections)</i> • Arguing convincingly that the ratification of the Constitution did not significantly change social structures in the United States, or that it reinforced the power of the elite. <i>(Qualifies an argument by considering diverse or alternative views or evidence)</i> • Corroborating an argument about increased federal power with economic evidence (e.g. taxation), social evidence (e.g. regulation of slavery in the territories), and evidence regarding America's role in the world (e.g. Quasi-War). <i>(Uses evidence to demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of different perspectives relevant to the prompt)</i>
	Additional Notes: • To earn the first point for analysis and reasoning, the response must use historical reasoning to structure a response to the prompt, although the reasoning might be uneven or imbalanced, or the evidence may be overly general or lacking in specificity. • This complex understanding must be part of the argument and may be demonstrated in any part of the response. • While it is not necessary for this complex understanding to be woven throughout the response, it must be more than merely a phrase or reference.		